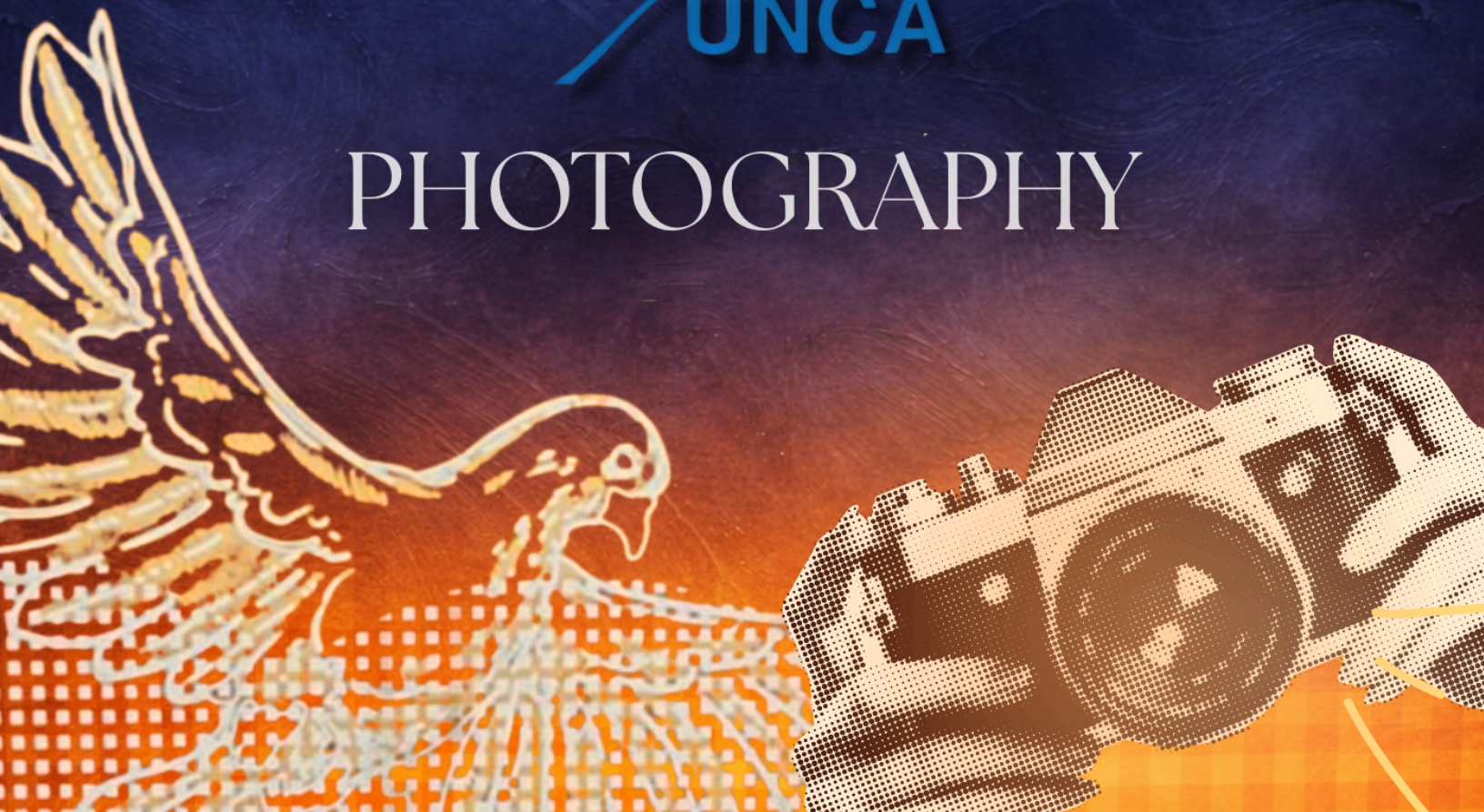


UNITED NATIONS  
CORRESPONDENTS  
ASSOCIATION



PHOTOGRAPHY



# Working of the Committee

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At Sanskriti Model United Nations, the United Nations Correspondents Association has crystallised itself as a creative outlet for writers, photographers and cartoonists. The UNCA separates itself from other committees at SMUN by covering its proceedings and debating issues that are highly relevant to the state of media today. Examples of such issues include the safety of the press and cases of erosion of freedom of speech. It is, but the perfect platform for developing one's incipient talent as a writer, cartoonist or photographer whilst acknowledging the complications of furnishing the masses with information.

The efforts of the budding delegates from across the three branches- Photography, Journalism, and Cartoonists- will be recognised in the online blog. Based purely on merit, a select few submissions will also be published in the daily newsletter. The newsletter aims to serve as a short-term goal to enhance one's written performance. Evaluating other people's work will also help add another perspective to one's photographs.

Every morning, the delegates are required to convene in their respective venues, where they will be briefed on that day's proceedings, their assignments for that session, and the qualitative and quantitative expectations for each assignment. They will be informed of the deadline for every task. Correspondents **must** meet every deadline, as is the expectation in modern-day press. Delays of any sort won't be looked upon favourably by the Executive Board.

It must be noted that members of the press are not allowed to interfere with committee procedure. They must simply observe it.

Please note that press members are allowed to carry and use electronic devices during the conference. Internet connectivity will, however, only be available in the UNCA room. Usage is only permitted for research purposes. Their usage for anything else is not looked at upon favourably by the Executive Board.

The use of tools such as Chat-GPT or AI humanisers or plagiarism is severely frowned



upon and will lead to immediate disqualification from the award process. Delegates are encouraged to uphold journalistic ethics in every action they take during this conference.

All lobbying must take place on a platform approved and monitored by the Executive Board. Offensive language is highly prohibited

and will lead to a direct disqualification from the awards process. All members of the Executive Board must be added to all WhatsApp groups created with the intention of lobbying.

# How to go about Research

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At the very basis of journalism lies the inveterate duty of journalists to report news and provide people with thoroughly well-researched information which is factually correct, as well as plausible to the utmost good faith. These factors are not the only ones which an article should comprise. An article must not only be well-written but should also cover both sides of the story and uncover iniquity in the journalist's pursuit of verity. In order to carry out this objective in the most scrupulous way possible, one must be thoroughly well acquainted with the news agency to which they have been assigned.

Here are a few pointers to keep in mind while going about your research as a member of the press of the United Nations Correspondents Association:

## **News Agency**

A news agency is the portfolio allotted to each journalist in the UNCA. It is, in essence, the better part of one's identity as a journalist. One must be thorough with the research of their allotted news agencies, which should include

their history, establishment, current status, accolades, etc.

## **Agency Bias**

Every journalist is allotted a news agency, which becomes their portfolio for the rest of the conference. When discussing the political spectrum, we're looking at the range of political opinions, from left to right ( the required information about the political spectrum is given on page 16). For example, left-leaning agencies often support progressive ideas like government involvement in healthcare or climate action. A well-known example of a left-leaning agency is The Wire. On the other hand, right-leaning agencies tend to support more traditional views, like limited government and free-market policies. Fox News is a good example of a right-leaning agency. Journalists are obligated to adopt the bias of their news agency throughout reporting and committee sessions, which depends on several factors such as ownership, political affiliations, and the country in which their news agency is based. Delegates are required to exhibit their understanding of their news

agency's bias in committee through article submissions **as well as the arguments put forth by them** during crisis discussions. Admitting one's bias goes against the ethics of journalism, hence no news agency can ever own up to being prejudiced, which provides news agencies a nuance most other portfolios lack.

Reading papers and visiting websites of the news agencies can help you to be exceedingly thorough with the agency's perspective.

### **Background Guides**

Delegates must familiarise themselves thoroughly with the background guide of the committee assigned to them. Background guides serve as the foundation for the

committee's agenda, and as the terminus a quo for the research a journalist is required to undertake. It is recommended that all journalists visit websites to learn more about the agenda and to acquire information for captions. It is also highly suggested that every point which is presented is meticulously verified and fact-checked.

It is recommended that delegates study international relations and world politics in order to be ready for any crisis. They may also review the matrix of the committees in order to gain a better understanding of their procedures.

# Procedural Guidelines

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In UNCA–Photography, Procedural guidelines regulate task execution, crisis conduct, submissions, movement, and delegate behaviour rather than formal debate. **Procedural guidelines must be followed throughout the conference. Failure to follow them will result in downmarking.**

## Points

### 1. Point of Personal Privilege

This point is used when a delegate experiences any personal discomfort or inconvenience that hinders their ability to participate in the committee.

For example, this point can be used if the delegate wants the Executive board or a fellow delegate to repeat anything.

### 2. Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

This point is used when a delegate needs clarification or has a question about committee procedure.

For example, this point can be used if a delegate requires clarification regarding the given task.

maximum time an unmoderated caucus can be raised for is 20 minutes.

How to raise the motion: “The delegate of The Hindu would like to raise a motion for an unmoderated caucus for a total time of 15 minutes.”

### 2. Motion for Extension:

This motion is used to extend an unmoderated caucus. It must be maintained that they can only be extended by half of the original time they were raised for.

For instance, if an unmoderated caucus was originally raised for 10 minutes, then for an extension, the motion would be raised by stating: “The delegate of the Agence France Press would like to raise a motion to extend the unmoderated caucus by a total of 5 minutes”

## Motions

### 1. Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus

During an Unmoderated Caucus, delegates are allowed to freely interact and coordinate amongst one another without formal moderation. It can be used during a verbal crisis. The

**Note: There is no paperwork.**